

TOM

Keep your Mac awake — and looking busy.

User Manual · Version 1.2

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1 What TOM does

TOM is a small, free, open-source menu bar and window app for macOS with four independent functions: keeping the Mac awake, and simulating a key press, mouse movement or a mouse click. Each one can run continuously or on a timer. This manual covers the parts that are not obvious from the app itself — installing an app that is not notarized by Apple, and granting the permission the simulation features need — and gives a short tour of every function.

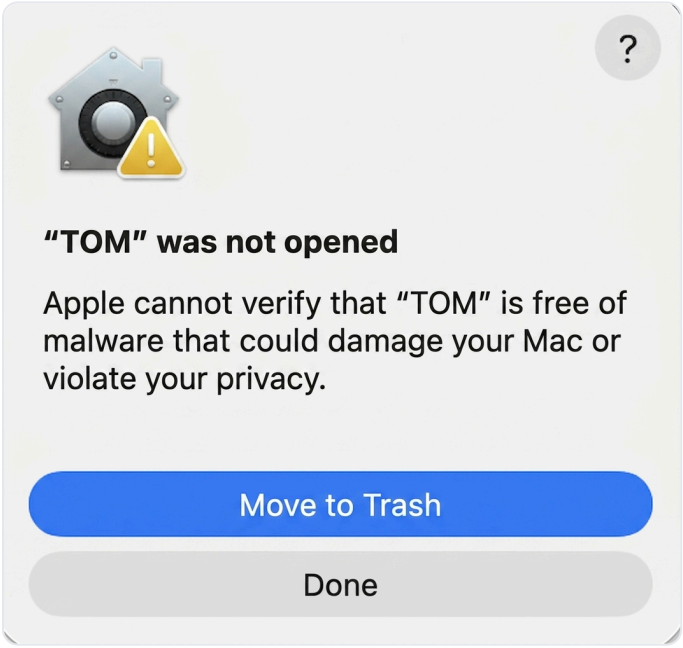
2 Installation

Download the latest release. There are two ways to install it:

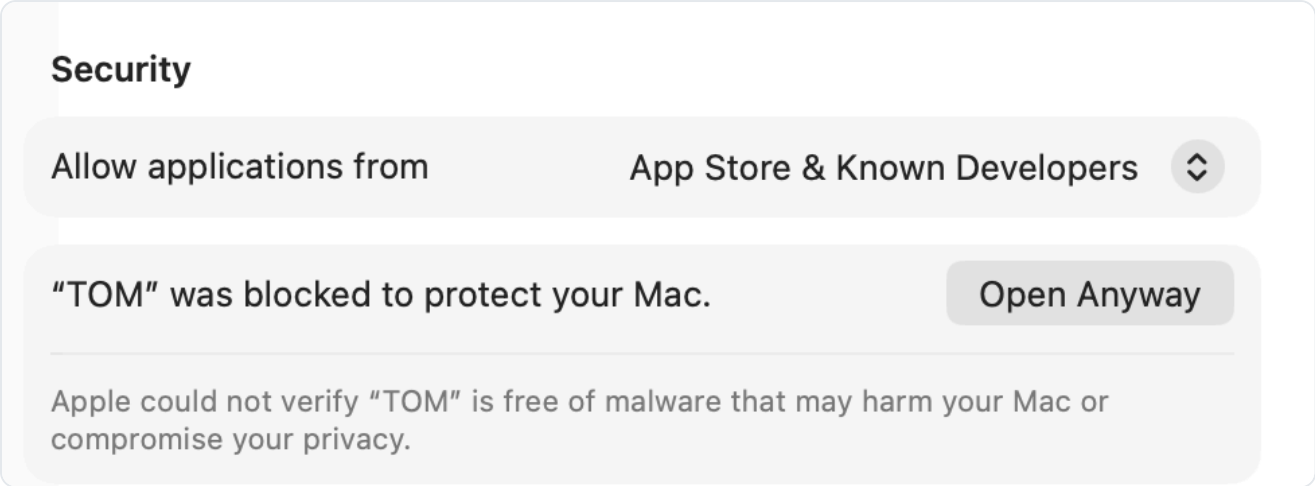
- **Installer (.dmg):** open it and drag TOM onto the Applications folder shown next to it.
- **Archive (.zip):** unzip it and move **TOM.app** to your Applications folder.

First launch: the security warning

TOM is signed locally but not notarized by Apple (notarization requires a paid developer account). The first time you open it, macOS blocks it and shows a warning like this one:



Click **Done** — do not move it to the Trash. Then open **System Settings → Privacy & Security** and scroll down to the Security section. You'll find a message about TOM there, with an **Open Anyway** button next to it:

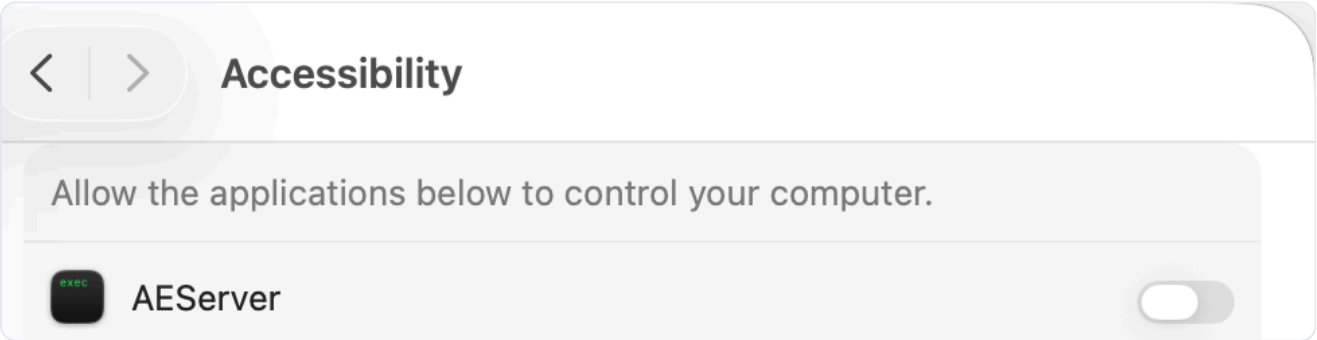


System Settings → Privacy & Security → Security

Click **Open Anyway**, confirm with your password or Touch ID, and TOM starts. You only need to do this once per downloaded copy of the app.

3 Granting the Accessibility permission

Keeping the Mac awake needs no special permission. The other three functions — simulating a key press, mouse movement, or a mouse click — do, because they send input events at the system level. TOM asks for this the first time you switch one of them on, and links directly to the right place:



System Settings → Privacy & Security → Accessibility. TOM appears in this list once it has asked for permission at least once.

Find **TOM** in the list and turn its switch on.

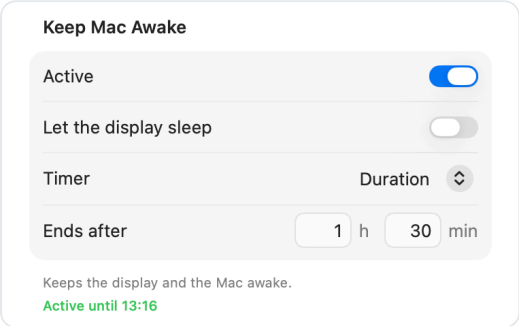
> **Good to know:** TOM is signed locally, not with a stable developer certificate. That means the permission can reset itself when you install a new version — if a simulation feature suddenly refuses to start after an update, open Accessibility settings, toggle TOM's switch off and back on, and try again.

4 The four functions

Keep Mac Awake is always visible. The three simulations sit in sections you can fold in and out by clicking their title — TOM remembers which ones were open. While a folded section is running, its title shows a green **Active** badge, including the end time if a timer is set.

Timer: every function has the same timer setting. **∞ Continuous** (the default) runs until you switch it off, **Duration** runs for the hours and minutes you enter, and **Until** runs until a time of day (tomorrow, if that time has already passed today). TOM shows when a running timer ends and then switches the function off by itself.

Keep Mac Awake



While switched on, the display and the system won't go to sleep due to inactivity — independent of your Energy Saver settings. No permission required.

Let the display sleep keeps only the Mac awake: downloads, renders and backups keep running while the screen still turns off as usual.

Simulate Key Press

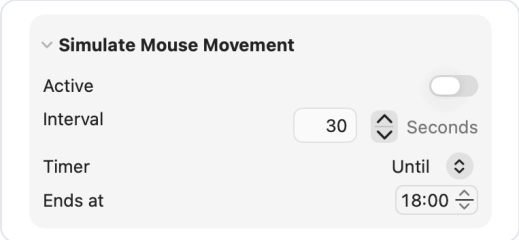


Sends a real key press. The key list follows your keyboard layout, so the letters shown match what's printed on your keys. Keys that can trigger something in the app in front or in macOS, such as Return, Tab or Esc, show a warning; the default F18 does nothing on its own. Choose a **Mode**:

- **Press** — a short press at the interval you set (1–600 seconds).
- **Hold** — the key stays down until you switch it off.
- **Hold & Pause** — held for the hold time, released for the pause, over and over.

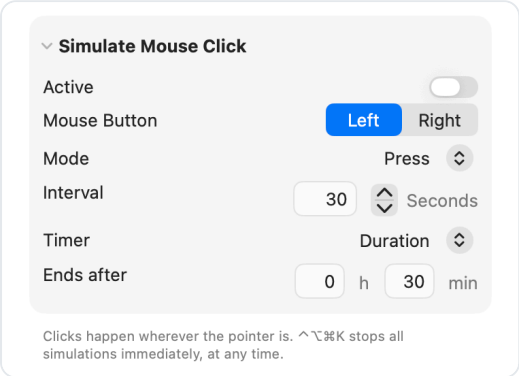
After switching on, TOM waits 5 seconds before it starts, so you can bring the target window to the front. A held key behaves like one that stays pressed down; it doesn't type the same character repeatedly the way holding a physical key in a text field would.

Simulate Mouse Movement



Nudges the pointer one pixel and immediately back, at the interval you set. No click, no visible movement — just enough for the system to register activity.

Simulate Mouse Click



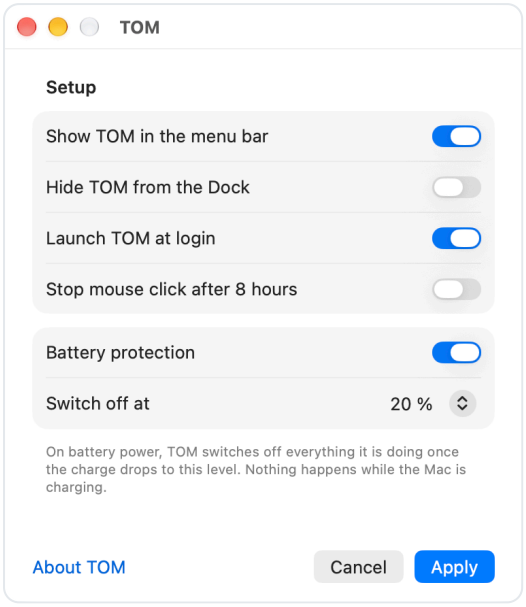
Works with the left or right mouse button wherever the pointer currently is, with the same three modes as the key press: **Press** clicks at an interval down to 0.1 seconds, **Hold** keeps the button down, **Hold & Pause** alternates. It also starts with a 5-second countdown and runs as long as you set — an optional 8-hour limit is available in Setup.

5 Safety

> **Emergency stop:** `^⌥⌘K` — stops key press, mouse click and mouse movement immediately, from any app, at any time, and releases any key or mouse button TOM is holding. It's shown in TOM's window whenever a simulation is running.

- Mouse movement and mouse click cannot run at the same time — switching one on turns the other off.
- No simulation remembers being switched on across a restart. You always start them manually.
- Quitting TOM releases anything it is holding down.
- If the Accessibility permission is withdrawn while a simulation runs, it switches off and TOM shows the permission hint again.

6 Setup



*Click **Setup** at the bottom left of TOM's window*

The Setup page holds the options that apply to the whole app. Changes take effect when you click **Apply**; **Cancel** discards them. Everything here is off by default.

- **Show TOM in the menu bar** — one-click access to the same controls from wherever you are. While anything is switched on, the icon shows a small green dot; while a timer runs, the time left appears next to it.
- **Hide TOM from the Dock** — TOM then lives in the menu bar only. Available while the menu bar icon is on, so TOM can always be reached.
- **Launch TOM at login** — starts TOM with your Mac. If macOS asks you to approve it, TOM links to the Login Items settings.
- **Stop mouse click after 8 hours** — a safety limit for a mouse click you might forget.
- **Battery protection** — on battery power, TOM switches everything off once the charge drops to the level you choose (5–50 %). Nothing happens while the Mac is charging. If you deliberately switch something back on afterwards, TOM leaves it running. This option only appears on Macs with a battery.

7 Uninstalling

If you switched on **Launch TOM at login**, switch it off in Setup first. Then quit TOM and move TOM.app from your Applications folder to the Trash. To also remove its saved settings, run this in Terminal:

```
defaults delete com.neonrost.TOM
```

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